

ALMILA BASAK

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs Syracuse University 024 Eggers Hall, Syracuse, New York 13244	@ abasak@syr.edu ☎ 315.560.8204
EDUCATION	Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science Syracuse University	2021 – 2027 (Expected)
	- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor) - Dissertation: <i>Varieties of Right-Wing Populism in Europe</i> - Committee: Seth K Jolly (Chair), Margarita Estevez-Abe, Jessie Trudeau	
	Master of Arts — Political Science Syracuse University	2021 – 2023
	Bachelor of Science - Political Science and Public Administration Middle East Technical University, Turkey Minor: Economics	2014 – 2019
ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Center for European Studies, Syracuse University	2024 – Present
	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Middle Eastern Studies Program, Syracuse University	2023 – Present
	Teaching Associate Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University	2023 – 2026

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS	Subfields: Political Parties, Populism, Comparative Political Economy, Politics of Social Policy, European Politics, Turkish Politics	
RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS	Graduate Research Assistant, <i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	Spring 2026
	Graduate Research Assistant, <i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	Spring 2025
	Graduate Research Assistant, <i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	2023-2024
	Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant,	

Dr. Thomas Keck

2022 – 2023

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	[6] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?" presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference.	April 2026
	[5] "The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil" presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference with Dr. Jessie Trudeau.	April 2026
	[4] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" presented at the European Union Studies Association Conference with Prof Seth Jolly.	May 2025
	[3] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?," presented at the American Political Science Association Conference.	September 2024
	[2] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP," presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association.	November 2022
	[1] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP," presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at Syracuse University.	September 2022

SKILLS	Statistics Software: R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, MAXQDA Document Preparation Systems: L ^A T _E X, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite
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WORKING PAPERS	[3] "Welfare Promises of Populist Right Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"	
	[2] "The Electoral Returns to Bending Campaign Rules: Evidence from Brazil" (with Dr. Trudeau)	
	[1] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" (with Dr. Jolly)	

Teaching

TEACHING ASSISTANT	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2025
	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2024

INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD	PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism	May 2024
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Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS

Summer Dissertation Fellowship <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	Spring 2026
Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research <i>Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	2025
Goekjian/Center for European Studies Research Grant <i>Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	2025
Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	Spring 2025
Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	2024
Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	2023
Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22

AWARDS

The Ketcham Award <i>For students whose work exhibits a commitment to open and just public life</i> <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	2026
Certificate in University Teaching <i>The Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University</i>	2026
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
Koff Award <i>The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics</i> <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	2025
Young Scholar Prize <i>For the paper "Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey"</i> <i>Middle East Studies Program, Syracuse University</i>	2023

HONORS

Graduated as first-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University's Political Science Department	June 2019
Graduated as third-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University	June 2019

Service

TO THE INSTITUTION	Co-President , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2023-2024
	Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2022-2023
	Political Science Department Representative , Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization, Graduate Pandemic Committee member	2021-2022
TO THE DISCIPLINE	Panelist , <i>Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student</i> organized by Future Professoriate Program	October 2025
	Organizer , <i>Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau</i> for Political Science Graduate Students.	October 2024
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar:</i> <i>"Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.	December 2023
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	European Political Science Society	2026 – Present
	Midwest Political Science Association	2026 – Present
	European Union Studies Association	2025 – Present
	American Political Science Association	2024 – Present

Updated April 30, 2026